Digital Banking KYC & Account Linking Platform – Case Study

Disclaimer: This case study was created independently to demonstrate my product management approach across exploration, design, and validation. It leverages self-research, ChatPRD for structured thinking, and v0 for prototyping. The concepts, visuals, and solutions presented are illustrative only.

The views expressed are my own and do not represent those of my employer, past clients, or any affiliated organizations.

To view the live prototype please visit: https://v0-hnw-kyc-onboarding-flow.vercel.app/

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TL;DR

Onboarding high-net-worth (HNW) clients was historically slow, redundant, and opaque—leading to frustrated clients, advisor bottlenecks, and delayed inflows. As product lead, I spearheaded the launch of a secure, mobile-first **Digital KYC & Account Linking Platform**. The solution delivered a **90% account linking success rate**, cut onboarding effort by **30%**, and accelerated asset inflows—all while maintaining audit-grade compliance.

Executive Summary

First impressions define client trust in private banking. Our legacy onboarding forced HNW clients through repetitive KYC checks and weeks of manual account aggregation. Competitors were already winning with digital-first, paperless experiences.

As **product lead**, I drove discovery, design, and launch of an integrated platform that combined:

- **Real-time identity verification**
- **10-category Source of Wealth capture** with dynamic follow-ups (e.g., employment, inheritance)
- **"One-click" account linking across institutions**
- **Instant status visibility for clients, advisors, and compliance**

This reduced friction, protected compliance, and elevated satisfaction. The outcome: **faster onboarding, stronger advisor engagement, and earlier asset funding**.

Goals

Business Goals

- Increase HNW onboarding completion by **30%+** in six months.
- Achieve **85–90% multi-account linking success rate**.
- Reduce manual compliance interventions by **25%**.
- Improve **client NPS** and **advisor satisfaction** on onboarding journey.

User Goals

- Mobile-first, **paperless onboarding** with real-time feedback.
- Transparent **progress tracking** for clients.

- Reduced redundant documentation.
- Advisors gain live visibility to intervene early.

Non-Goals

- Replacing CRM or end-to-end compliance automation.
- Sharing client data without explicit consent.

Exploration

Context & Rationale
Onboarding was a major source of client attrition. HNW prospects compared us to fintech challengers who promised instant, digital-first access. Internal metrics showed >40% drop-off at the **account linking stage** and average onboarding timelines exceeding two weeks.

Insights & Research

- **Client interviews:** “I uploaded the same document three times and still didn’t know my status.”
- **Advisor feedback:** Needed visibility to anticipate stalls.
- **Compliance input:** Manual reviews were a bottleneck, especially for Source of Wealth validation.
- **Data analysis:** 40% abandonment at linking stage, 25% compliance rework on KYC documents.

Hypothesis
Streamlining identity verification, broadening SoW categories, and introducing one-click account linking with transparent progress updates would **lift completion rates and reduce compliance workload**.

User Stories

- As an HNW client, I want to **upload documents once** and track progress in real time.
- As an HNW client, I want to **declare Source of Wealth across multiple categories** (employment, inheritance, real estate, business) without repeating forms.
- As an advisor, I want a **dashboard view** of client onboarding status and alerts when clients stall.

- As a compliance officer, I want **audit logs and automated document validation** to reduce manual review time.

Functional Requirements

- Document upload with **real-time validation** (passport, proof of address, proof of income).
- **10 SoW categories** with conditional follow-ups (e.g., Employment → employer, role, tenure, income band).
- **Secure account linking** (banking + brokerage), with fallback for manual entry.
- **Shared progress tracker** for clients, advisors, and compliance.
- End-to-end **audit logging** with consent capture.

Design

Key UX Flows:

1. **Start Onboarding** – Mobile-first welcome, personalized for HNW.
2. **Document Upload** – Simple upload cards + progress bar.
3. **Source of Wealth** – 10 categories; conditional questions (Employment → employer, income range; Inheritance → relation, estate value).
4. **Account Linking** – Secure Plaid/Yodlee-like integration; success/failure recovery.
5. **Progress Tracker** – Persistent tracker for both clients and advisors.
6. **Confirmation** – “Onboarding Complete” + advisor introduction.

User Experience:

- Clients: Guided workflow, persistent indicators, save/resume.
- Advisors: Dashboard with alerts + early engagement prompts.
- Compliance: Auto-generated logs, reduced manual review.

- ## Mockups/Prototypes

Welcome to Global Wealth Onboarding

Your exclusive gateway to premium wealth management services. We're honored to serve distinguished clients like yourself.

Bank-Grade Security

Your data is protected with enterprise-level encryption

Premium Service

Dedicated support from our wealth management experts

Trusted by 10,000+

High-net-worth individuals worldwide

Ready to Begin?

The onboarding process takes approximately 5-7 minutes and ensures compliance with international financial regulations.

Start KYC Process

By proceeding, you agree to our Terms of Service and Privacy Policy

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Document Verification

Please upload the required documents for identity verification

Step 2 of 5 — 3 of 3 completed

Government-Issued ID Required

Passport or National ID Card

Document uploaded successfully

Proof of Address Required

Utility bill or bank statement (last 3 months)

Document uploaded successfully

Proof of Income Required

Tax return, pay stub, or financial statement

Document uploaded successfully

Your documents are secure

All uploads are encrypted and stored in compliance with international data protection standards

Continue to Source of Wealth

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Source of Wealth

Please select all sources that contribute to your wealth (multiple selections allowed)

Step 3 of 5 — 1 sources selected

Employment
Salary and employment income

Business Ownership
Business profits and ownership

Investments
Stocks, bonds, and securities

Real Estate
Property investments and rentals

Inheritance
Inherited assets and wealth

Gifts/Trusts
Gifts and trust distributions

Sale of Assets
Sale of valuable assets

Savings/Deposits
Bank savings and deposits

Pension/Retirement
Retirement and pension funds

Other Source
Please specify if your wealth comes from sources not listed above

Describe your other source of wealth...

Regulatory Compliance
This information is required for AML/KYC compliance and will be kept strictly confidential

Continue to Details

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Tell us more about your employment income.

Please provide comprehensive details about your current employment

Step 4 of 6 Employment Details

Employment Information

Please provide comprehensive details about your current employment

Basic Information

Employer Name *

Enter your employer's name

Industry/Sector *

Select your industry

Job Title / Position *

Enter your job title

Years with Current Employer *

Enter number of years

Country of Employment *

Select country

Compensation Details

Annual Gross Income Range *

Select income range

☐ I receive bonus/variable compensation

Privacy & Compliance: Your information is used only for KYC purposes and kept fully confidential. We employ bank-level security to protect your data.

Continue

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Account Linking

Securely connect your existing financial accounts for a comprehensive wealth overview

Step 5 of 5 | 0 accounts linked

95% Success Rate
Our secure linking technology successfully connects to most major financial institutions

JPMorgan Chase Bank — Link Account	**Bank of America** Bank — Link Account
Wells Fargo Bank — Link Account	**Goldman Sachs** Investment Bank — Link Account
Morgan Stanley Investment Bank — Link Account	**Charles Schwab** Brokerage — Link Account
Fidelity Brokerage — Link Account	**Vanguard** Investment — Link Account

Bank-Level Security

- 256-bit SSL encryption for all data transmission
- Read-only access - we cannot initiate transactions
- Credentials are never stored on our servers
- Compliant with PCI DSS and SOC 2 Type II standards

Skip for Now

You can link accounts later from your dashboard

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Account Linking

Securely connect your existing financial accounts for a comprehensive wealth overview

Step 5 of 5 — 1 accounts linked

95% Success Rate
Our secure linking technology successfully connects to most major financial institutions

JPMorgan Chase Bank — Unlink	**Bank of America** Bank — Link Account
Wells Fargo Bank — Link Account	**Goldman Sachs** Investment Bank — Link Account
Morgan Stanley Investment Bank — Link Account	**Charles Schwab** Brokerage — Link Account
Fidelity Brokerage — Link Account	**Vanguard** Investment — Link Account

Bank-Level Security

- 256-bit SSL encryption for all data transmission
- Read-only access - we cannot initiate transactions
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- Compliant with PCI DSS and SOC 2 Type II standards

Complete Onboarding

Welcome to Global Wealth!

Your onboarding is complete. We're excited to begin this exclusive wealth management journey with you.

Your Onboarding Summary

Documents Verified

✓ Government-issued ID
✓ Proof of address
✓ Proof of income

Wealth Sources

✓ Employment

Connected Accounts

1 financial account successfully linked

Schedule Your First Consultation

Meet with your dedicated wealth advisor to discuss your financial goals and investment strategy.

Schedule Consultation

Contact Your Advisor

Your personal wealth advisor, Sarah Chen, is ready to assist you with any questions.

Message Sarah Chen

What Happens Next?

1. Our compliance team will review your documents within 24-48 hours
2. You'll receive account activation confirmation via email
3. Your advisor will reach out to schedule your welcome consultation

Narrative

Priya, an HNW client, begins onboarding on her phone. She uploads her passport, selects “Employment” and “Investments” as sources of wealth, and links her brokerage account in two clicks. Her progress is visible at all times.

Her advisor, Rahul, sees Priya’s journey in real time, is alerted to a document retry, and guides her via a single call. Compliance receives an audit-ready log, reducing review time. Priya completes onboarding in **2 days**, funds her account the same week, and rates her experience highly.

Testing

Pilot: 200 HNW clients.

- A/B tested **instruction clarity** → completion ↑ 15%.
- **Usability tests:** cut steps from 8 → 5.
- Account linking success ↑ to 90%.
- Average onboarding time ↓ 30%.

Merchant quote:

> *“For the first time, I knew exactly where I was in the process—no guesswork, no chasing paperwork.”*

Success Metrics

- Onboarding completion ↑ 30%.
- Account linking success ↑ 90%.
- Compliance intervention ↓ 25%.
- Advisor satisfaction ↑ measurable NPS lift.

Technical Architecture

- API-driven, modular service layer for onboarding.
- **Identity verification vendor** integration for KYC.

- **Account linking engine** using secure open-banking APIs (with retry logic).
- Event-driven **real-time status tracker** across client, advisor, compliance portals.
- Encrypted cloud storage; GDPR/CCPA compliant.

AI Considerations

- AI-driven **document validation** and anomaly detection → reduce false positives.
- **Explainable AI models** with human-in-loop review.
- Future: Proactive **fraud pattern detection** across client onboarding.
- Strict **PII governance**: no external model training with client data.

Milestones

- **MVP:** 3 months – digital KYC + basic account linking.
- **Pilot:** 6 months – rolled out to 200 HNW clients.
- **Launch:** 9 months – scale to all wealth clients.
- **Phase 2:** AI-driven document validation & expanded account linking coverage.

Results & Readout

- Onboarding time cut by 30%.
- Drop-off rate ↓ by one-third.
- Account linking success = 90%.
- Compliance manual reviews ↓ 25%.
- Advisors engaged earlier, with richer client context.
- Flagship client onboarded in **2 days** vs. weeks.

Reflection & Next Steps

What Worked:

- Persistent status tracking + plain-language instructions were most impactful.
- Early compliance involvement prevented downstream blockers.

What Didn't:

- Initial flows overloaded clients with multiple uploads → simplified sequencing improved outcomes.

Next:

- Expand account linking to international wealth platforms.
- Deploy AI validation at scale.
- Build **advisor-facing analytics** for proactive engagement.